

#### NIGHTMARE HUNTERS ►

Many deep-ocean predators like this fangtooth have gaping mouths and long teeth to snare their prey. Yet most of these nightmare hunters are fairly small, since prey is too scarce to support big-bodied predators.

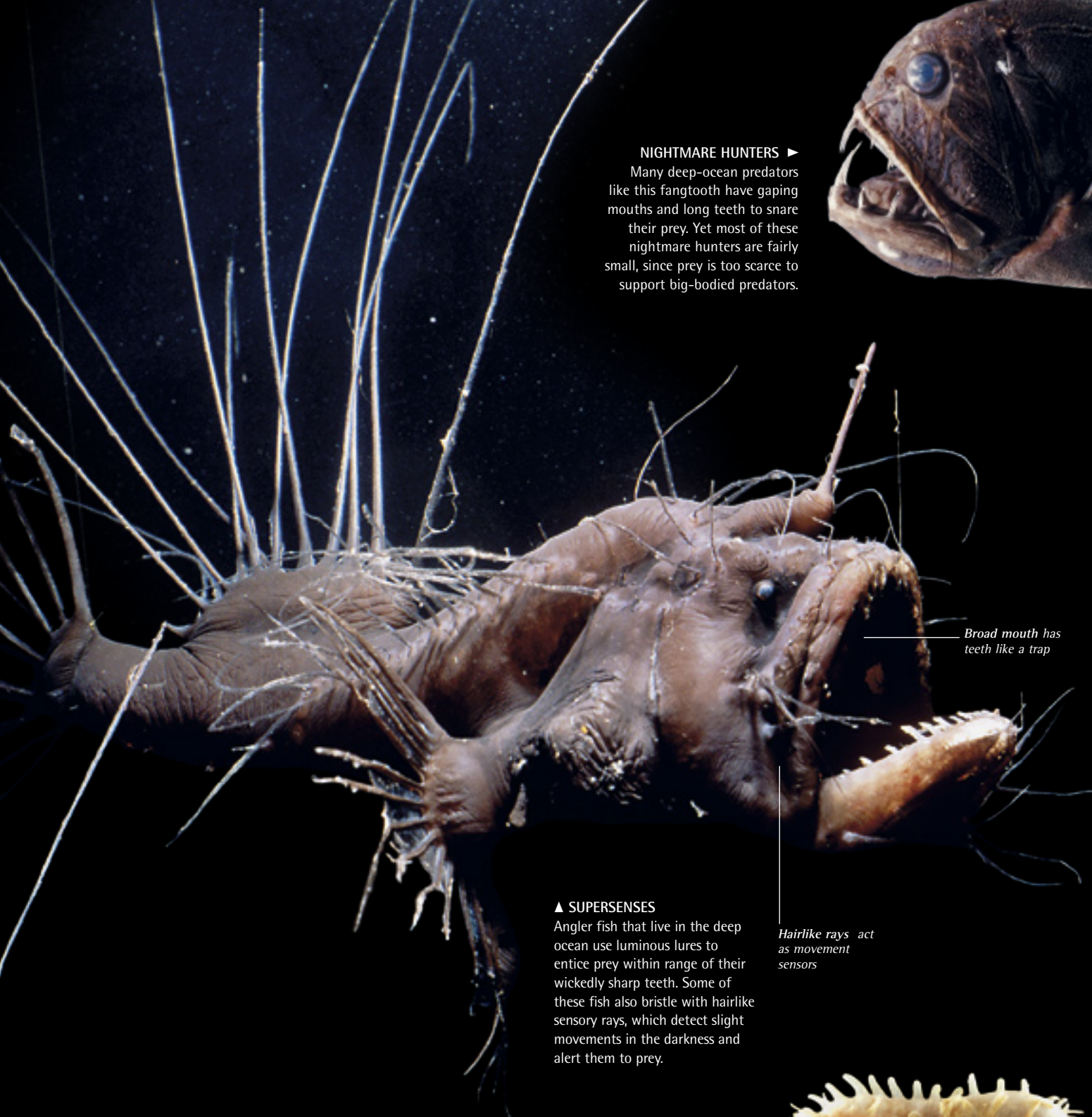


Broad mouth has teeth like a trap

#### ▲ SUPERSENSES

Angler fish that live in the deep ocean use luminous lures to entice prey within range of their wickedly sharp teeth. Some of these fish also bristle with hairlike sensory rays, which detect slight movements in the darkness and alert them to prey.

Hairlike rays act as movement sensors



#### ◀ SCAVENGERS OF THE DEEP

Dead animals that drift down from above are attacked by a variety of scavengers, including deep-water crustaceans such as amphipods and shrimps, rat-tail fish, and the slimy, eel-like hagfish shown here. Yet many carcasses take so long to sink through the deep, dark water that they are eaten before they reach the bottom.



#### MUD PROCESSORS ▲

The abyssal plains are populated by animals such as this sea cucumber, or holothurian, which suck up the sediments, swallow them, and digest any food. The mud and ooze are full of buried crustaceans, worms, and microbes, which feed beneath the surface of the ocean floor. Together, they gather every grain of food that reaches the bottom of the ocean.